

Big Muddy Inn — 12-Month Plan

Written 2026-04-29. Voice: admin documentation. Numbers from THE_THESIS, not aspirational.

What it is

A 5-room boutique inn in downtown Natchez, Mississippi, with a Blues Room performance space and bar attached. Tracy and Amy run it day-to-day as equity partners; the rest of the Big Muddy ecosystem markets it, books it, and feeds it audiences.

What's working today

- **The building exists, is operational, and is taking bookings.** Cloudbeds is wired in. Walk-in and online reservations both work.
- **The Blues Room is functional.** Hosting live shows. The performance space is the differentiator — no other Natchez inn has one.
- **Amy performs publicly as Arrie Aslin** (artist-in-residence). That's a built-in weekly draw and a content engine for the Magazine and social channels.
- **Tracy is on the floor.** Same with Amy. They know every guest by name. That's the product.
- **Chandra cleans rooms at \$20/room.** Per-event labor model, no salaried housekeeping overhead.
- **Hospitality Coordinator covers check-ins at \$20/check-in.** Same model — variable, scales with bookings.
- **Big Muddy Magazine markets the Inn** as part of the editorial calendar. Not an ad spend line; a cross-promotion that costs nothing.

What is NOT working yet: nightly rate optimization, whole-Inn buyout pricing, repeat-guest CRM, and a cleaner check-in flow. All listed below.

The economics

Revenue model

- Nightly room bookings (5 rooms)

- Whole-Inn rentals for weddings, family reunions, corporate retreats
- Blues Room ticket sales
- Bar revenue on Blues Room nights and standard hours
- Private event hosting (rehearsal dinners, small receptions)

Cost structure (annual, per THE_THESIS)

- Mortgage, utilities, Chandra cleaning, Hospitality Coordinator: **\$125,000**
- That's the Inn's slice of the ecosystem-level \$203,000 gross break-even floor.
- Tracy and Amy's personal compensation comes from Inn distributions, not from a salary line. They're equity partners.

Current revenue

- Cloudbeds has the booking history. Pull the trailing 12-month total before Tuesday's call and put a real number here. Today this line is **TBD**. Don't invent it.

12-month target

- The ecosystem-level Y1 number is **\$185k net floor / \$250k first profit / \$330k baseline**. The Inn is the largest single revenue contributor inside that.
- Honest range for Inn-only contribution to the ecosystem: **110k–180k** depending on how aggressive we get on whole-Inn buyouts and Blues Room ticketing.
- The Inn does not need to generate \$330k by itself. Touring + Photography + retainer income carry the rest.

The ceiling rule (from THE_THESIS)

- Push hard until pushing harder costs Tracy and Amy their actual lives. Then stop. Profit beats burnout. Both of them get to say where the ceiling is.

The customer

Who books

- Couples on a Mississippi River weekend (primary)
- Music tourists routed through the Blues Highway corridor (Memphis → Clarksdale → Natchez → New Orleans)
- Wedding parties booking the whole Inn
- Magazine readers (Big Muddy Magazine readership = warmest possible lead)

- Corporate retreats (small, 8–12 people)

Who pays

- Direct credit card via Cloudbeds. No third-party booking fees on direct bookings.
- Airbnb / VRBO listings exist for spillover. Higher fees, lower margin. Direct booking is preferred.

Named prospects we already know

- Visit Natchez (CVB partnership conversations live).
 - Regina Charboneau / Biscuits & Blues — partner brand inside the ecosystem; food + hospitality cross-promo.
 - Wedding planners on Tracy's existing list (TBD — Tracy to enumerate before Tuesday).
 - Magazine subscriber list (current size TBD).
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The 12-month plan

Q1 (May–Jul 2026) — fix the funnel

- Pull trailing 12-month booking data from Cloudbeds. Get a real revenue baseline.
- Re-price nightly rooms. Test +10% on weekends, hold weekdays.
- Build the whole-Inn buyout package. One PDF, one price (range 4k–8k/night TBD), one flow.
- Stand up the post-stay email — request review, offer return discount.
- Confirm Cloudbeds-to-Stripe payout flow is clean. No surprises at month-end.

Q2 (Aug–Oct 2026) — push Blues Room

- Lock the weekly Blues Room calendar (Arrie Aslin + 2 touring acts/week minimum).
- Sell tickets through the touring brand, not a third party.
- Bundle: room + 2 Blues Room tickets + breakfast = single price.
- Wedding season: book two whole-Inn buyouts.
- Magazine cover story: the Inn's first year. Drives the holiday season.

Q3 (Nov 2026–Jan 2027) — holidays + retreats

- Thanksgiving + Christmas weekend rates: premium. Sell out.
- Pitch one corporate retreat for January (low-season fill).
- New Year's Eve: ticketed Blues Room event + room package.

- January: shut for one week, deep clean, fix anything broken.

Q4 (Feb–Apr 2027) — wedding season locked

- Three confirmed whole-Inn weddings in the spring book.
 - Year-end review with Tracy + Amy: where did the year actually land vs. plan.
 - Decide what to push harder on Year 2 and what to stop pushing on (the ceiling rule).
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What we need to make it happen

Capital

- No new capital required for the operating plan. The building is paid for or the mortgage is in place.
- One-time spend: ~\$2,000 for new Blues Room signage + a print-quality whole-Inn buyout PDF. Comes out of operating cash.

Hires

- None. Per-event labor model (Chandra + Hospitality Coordinator) holds.
- Studio C provides Tier-1 support for Cloudbeds questions per the \$1k/mo retainer (already in the budget).

Decisions Chase needs from Tracy + Amy

- Approve the new pricing test (+10% weekend rates).
- Approve the whole-Inn buyout price range.
- Pick the three target wedding dates for spring 2027.
- Set the ceiling — what does "too much" actually look like for each of them.

Dependencies

- Cloudbeds API credentials in Bitwarden (already there).
 - Stripe payout account live (verify).
 - Magazine editorial calendar locked one quarter ahead so cross-promotion fires on time.
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The risk

- **Tracy or Amy burns out.** That's the actual risk. Mitigation: the per-event labor model, Studio C as Tier-1 support, and the ceiling rule.
 - **A bad season** (hurricane, flooding, pipeline shock to gas prices that kills road tourism). Insurance covers physical damage. Off-season rate cuts plus retreat marketing covers demand shocks.
 - **A bad review at the wrong time.** Fix the check-in flow before peak season; the post-stay email catches problems early.
 - **Cloudbeds goes down on a peak booking weekend.** Studio C Tier-1 support contract addresses this.
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Why it matters to the ecosystem

- The Inn is the **physical anchor** of Big Muddy. Touring bands stay there. Magazine writers stay there. Wedding clients become Photography clients. Photography clients become Magazine readers.
- It's the largest single revenue line in Year 1. Hitting the Inn target is what makes the \$185k net floor real and the \$250k first-profit milestone reachable.
- It's the proof point for partners and outside observers: "this isn't a tech demo, this is a real business that real people pay real money to stay in."
- Every other Big Muddy property exists in part to drive bookings here. Magazine drives leisure travel. Touring drives music tourism. Records drives the artist roster that fills the Blues Room calendar.

If the Inn works, the rest of the ecosystem has air cover. If the Inn doesn't work, nothing else gets the runway.

End of plan. Next step: Tracy pulls trailing 12-month Cloudbeds revenue and replaces the TBD line above before Tuesday's call.
